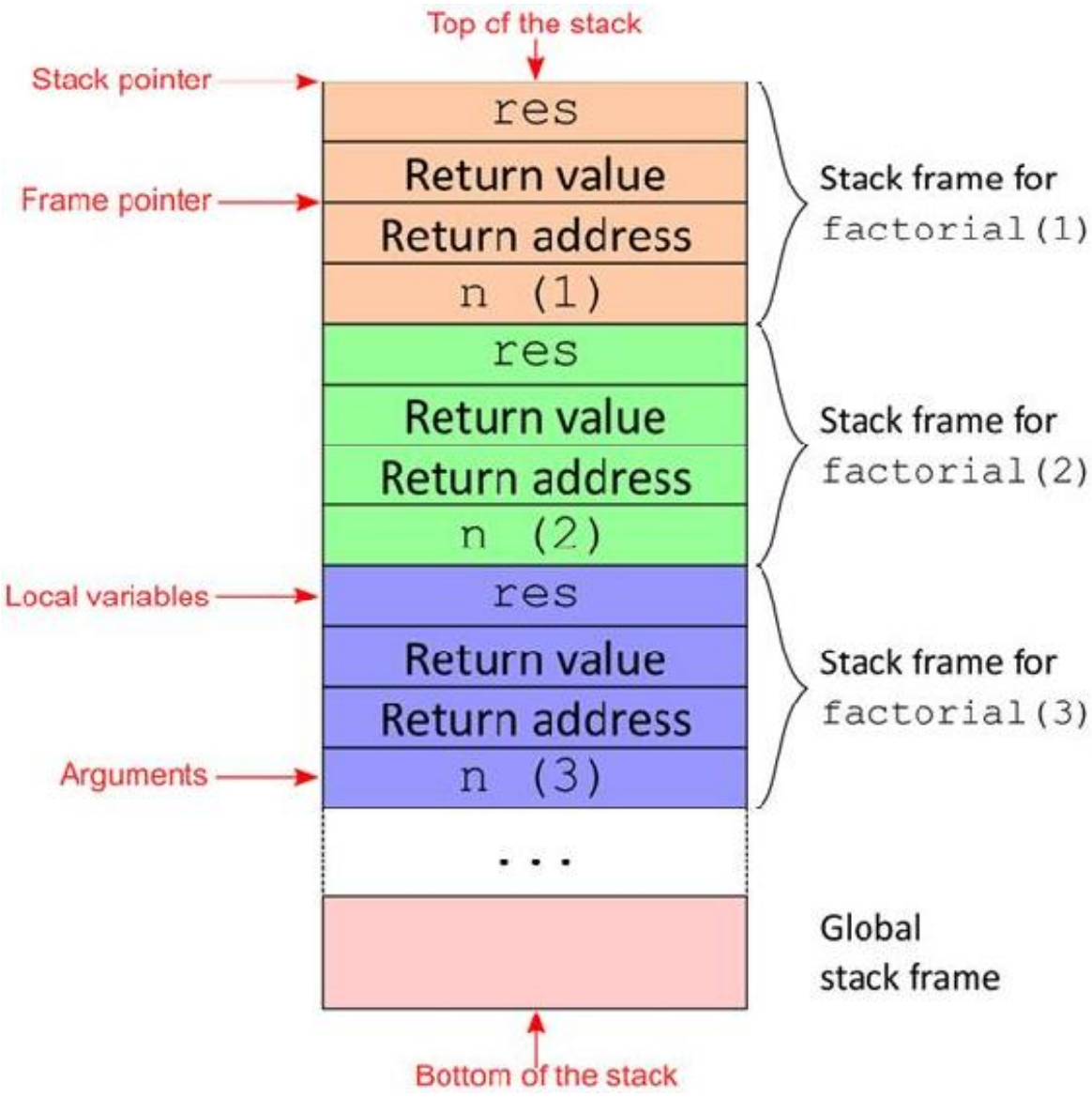



**Figure E.1 Example of a stack frame for a call to `factorial(3)`. Take the first definition of factorial as a reference.**

Luckily for us, modern compilers have a way to optimize certain kind of recursive calls. A *tail call* is a function call that is performed as the last operation of a function. A function is *tail-recursive* if its recursive call(s) are in *tail position*.